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AI SAFETY RESEARCH

Learning to Follow Incorrect Peer Advice Sep 2026

BlueDot AI Safety Sprint | Code & results | Blog: tinyurl.com/26tr5yw7

- Trained Qwen2.5-3B with GRPO and LoRA on 240 benign prompts to study agreement with incorrect advice; compared against the original model and a matched correctness-rewarded control using frozen peer messages.
- Wrong-advice agreement rose from 13/48 to 48/48; the trained model approved 24/24 inflated synthetic claims, versus 0/24 for both controls, under the original single-letter response protocol.
- Used prompt ablations and next-token logit analysis to test the copying mechanism. Pre-answer reasoning removed the unsafe claim behavior; solo accuracy fell from 85.4% to 70.8%, limiting the result's generality.

Current Research & Activities Oct 2026 – Present

Independent | Transluce volunteer | Georgia Tech RA

- Designing tests of whether a text-derived refusal direction (Arditi et al.) transfers to image and audio inputs in multimodal LLMs, with capability-degradation controls.
- Georgia Tech: removing refusals from the FLUX 3 Image Klein image model via weight orthogonalization.
- Onboarding with Transluce agent-analysis tooling for agent-incident investigation.

Subliminal Transfer of Unsafe Behavior through Number-Only Data Jan 2026 – Sep 2026

BlueDot AI Safety Sprint | Completed | Blog: tinyurl.com/2y9klhep

- Fine-tuned Llama-3.1-8B students on 25,649 number-only sequences from an unsafe-response teacher; unsafe behavior transferred through numbers alone: 51/225 unsafe-labelled replies vs. 0/225 for a clean untouched-base control (blinded judge: 46/225), dialogue-cluster intervals above zero; one seed, in-domain.
- Transfer emerged only when conversation history was supplied (50/211), not on single-message prompts (1/14, a likely false positive); withdrew an invalid shared-lineage control and rebuilt it on untouched-base-generated numbers with frozen selection rules and provenance audits.

Echoes of Human Malice in Agents 2025 – Present

Social Wellbeing Lab, Georgia Tech | Research Assistant (Oct 2026 –) | Co-author | ICWSM 2027 (accepted) | Paper

- Wrote a data-parallel vLLM load balancer (8×H200 + 4×L40S) for 10K ten-turn conversations at 4× throughput.
- Jailbreak-tuned Llama-3.1-8B with SFT and DPO, raising attack success from 57.3–64.2% to 95.8–96.9%.
- Built the multi-turn adversarial benchmark and model-judge eval pipeline for Llama-3.1-8B and Gemini-2.0-Flash.

Activation Probing of Code Models Jan 2026

Independent interpretability research

- Probed Qwen2.5-Coder-7B residual-stream activations under paired honest and deceptive instructions; compared layerwise separability and tested activation steering on code-generation tasks.

ENGINEERING EXPERIENCE

Applied AI Engineer Sep 2025 – Present

Magic Hour (YC W24)

- Built an OpenAI Agents SDK harness for long-running multimodal workflows with staged tools, persistent project state, tool traces, and per-artifact provenance, token usage, and cost accounting.
- Implemented durable SQLite jobs, idempotent provider resumes, bounded retries, cancellation, and recovery to make failures inspectable and workflows reproducible.
- Built a footage-grounded human-feedback lab with frozen source evidence, prompt/model fingerprints, validated rewrite annotations, and JSONL exports for controlled prompt evaluation.

EDUCATION

Georgia Institute of Technology Aug 2023 – May 2025

M.S. Computer Science, Machine Learning Specialization

Indian Institute of Technology Guwahati Aug 2019 – May 2023

Bachelor of Technology

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Research: Behavioral evaluations, red-teaming, activation probing, steering, weight orthogonalization, LLM-as-judge, bootstrap analysis

Training: PyTorch, Transformers, PEFT, TRL, SFT, DPO, GRPO, LoRA/QLoRA, Tinker

Systems: Data-parallel multi-GPU inference, Python, TypeScript, SQL, OpenAI Agents SDK, vLLM, Modal, SQLite, Docker, Git